

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Jajmani anatomy

JAJMAN -> patron household, usually landholding

KAMIN -> designated hereditary service group

SERVICE -> barbering, laundry, priestly, carpentry, smithing

PAYMENT -> customary, often grain or kind, sometimes cash

MUST REMEMBER: Rural society combines caste, class, land, labour, credit, kinship, panchayat, market and state relations; agrarian change follows tenure reform, Green Revolution, mechanisation, commercialisation, feminisation, migration, non-farm diversification and ecological stress.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: What actually defined jajmani

NOT -> the absence of cash in the transaction

YES -> hereditary allocation of the service role

YES -> personalised patron-client obligation

YES -> caste occupation embedded in the village economy

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Decline mechanism

COMMERCIALISATION -> patrons buy services in a market

NON-FARM WORK -> service castes migrate to towns for wages

DECOUPLING -> hereditary occupation-caste link breaks

RESIDUAL -> ritual and personalised ties survive in places

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Agrarian class ladder

LANDOWNING CULTIVATOR -> controls land and surplus

TENANT OR SHARECROPPER -> cultivates with insecure claim

LANDLESS LABOURER -> depends on wage work

OVERLAP -> class often but not always tracks caste rank

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Dominant caste test

NUMBERS -> locally numerous population

LAND -> significant share of village land

OFFICE -> control of Panchayat and political networks

RESULT -> local power can sit below the ritual top

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Two categories kept apart

DOMINANT CASTE -> caste-level, numbers plus land plus office

LANDOWNING CLASS -> economic category cutting across castes

USUAL CASE -> the two largely coincide in a village

ERROR PREVENTED -> treating them as the same unit

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Green Revolution differentiation

INPUT PACKAGE -> high-yielding seed, irrigation, fertiliser

REQUIREMENT -> upfront capital, credit and market access

EFFECT -> earlier adopters capture a larger share of gains

LIMIT -> outcome varies by crop, tenancy and region

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Panchayat power test

RESERVED SEAT -> Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women

QUESTION -> who sets the agenda in practice

PROXY RISK -> informal dominant-caste network controls decisions

EVIDENCE NEEDED -> village-level, not a national statistic

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Continuum against dichotomy

DICHOTOMY -> village traditional, town modern, sealed apart

CONTINUUM -> one spectrum linked by flows

FLows -> migration, remittance, trade, media, road and market

CAUTION -> linkage does not abolish remoteness or land relations

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Scope discipline

SOCIETY OWNS -> jajmani, dominance, stratification, continuum

ECONOMY OWNS -> land ceiling, tenancy law, poverty aggregates

GOVERNANCE OWNS -> Panchayati Raj institutional design

RULE -> cross-refer the borrowing and label it

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rural is not agricultural, landowner is not cultivator, farmer is not only title-holder, productivity is not income, agricultural labour is not bonded labour, and Panchayati Raj representation is not the same as effective decision-making power.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Measurement boundary

PLFS 2023-24 -> dated rural workforce comparator

PLFS ANNUAL REPORT 2025 -> released March 2026, latest round

PERIOD -> January to December, not the older July to June cycle

LIMIT -> cannot prove jajmani decline or caste dominance

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Contrast Punjab-Haryana, eastern India, dryland Deccan, plantation, tribal and peri-urban regions; use Agriculture Census, Situation Assessment and labour data with period/coverage labels, and treat technology-policy correlations as mechanisms requiring land, water, market and power analysis.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Rural answer spine

OPEN -> name the changing power relation, not a village portrait

BODY -> jajmani change, class structure, dominance, Panchayat

FRAME -> which resource now carries power in this village

CLOSE -> continuum verdict with the data and scope caveats